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Week 17 Logic Lab

SELF-DECEPTION AND PRIVATE JUSTIFICATION

Purpose: Apply a multi-tool Whately autopsy to fresh cases of self-justification: name desire, conclusion, hidden assumption, flaw, and a repaired narrower claim.

Part 1: Desire and Conclusion

Question 1.1

After missing two practices, a starter tells himself, “The coach is unfair, so I deserve to start anyway.” Name the desire or feared loss and the conclusion he wants.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

A student who has not opened the novel says, “I work better under pressure, so waiting until tonight is actually smart planning.” Name the desire and the conclusion.

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Hidden Assumption and Tool

Question 2.1

“I already put hours into this group project, therefore my method is the best method.” Surface the hidden assumption and name one Whately tool that exposes the flaw.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

“My friend said the shortcut is safe, and my friend always has my back, so the shortcut is safe.” Surface the weak move and name the prior-week credibility or proof tool that tests it.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Private Argument and Public Cover

Question 3.1

Privately, a club officer wants the title for college applications. Publicly, the officer says, “I am running only because the club needs continuity.” What is the private argument, what is the public cover, and what independent support would the public cover need?

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

A driver who was texting says, “Anyone would have looked down for a second; the real problem is these sudden stoplights.” Identify the rationalization and a repaired claim that stays closer to the facts.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Full Self-Deception Autopsy

Question 4.1

Read the paragraph. Complete a self-deception autopsy: desire, conclusion, stated reasons, hidden assumption, one exposing tool, what still needs judgment or evidence, and a repaired narrower claim.

Jordan wants the lead in the spring play. After a shaky audition, Jordan thinks: “The director likes people who look confident. I looked nervous, but that is only because I care more than the others. Caring that much means I should get the part. If I do not get it, the process was biased. Anyway, everyone says hard workers are rewarded, and no one works harder than I do in my head.”

Part 4 Q1

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Part 5: Review

Question 5.1

A campaign video shows slow music, a torn flag, and the line “Trust me—I am one of you,” then asks voters to reject a budget report they have not read. Use a prior-week rhetoric tool: what is the rhetorical force, and what remains unproved?

Part 5 Q1

Question 5.2

Two students argue whether a punishment was “fair.” After they agree fair means “same rule applied the same way,” they still disagree about the facts of the case. Use a prior-week dispute tool: classify the remaining disagreement.

Part 5 Q2